

CSS Text

CSS has a lot of properties for formatting text.

TEXT FORMATTING

This text is styled with some of the text formatting properties. The heading uses the text-align, text-transform, and color properties. The paragraph is indented, aligned, and the space between characters is specified. The underline is removed from this colored [Try it Yourself](#) link.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
div {
  border: 1px solid gray;
  padding: 8px;
}

h1 {
  text-align: center;
  text-transform: uppercase;
  color: #4CAF50;
}

p {
  text-indent: 50px;
  text-align: justify;
  letter-spacing: 3px;
}

a {
  text-decoration: none;
  color: #008CBA;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>

<div>
  <h1>text formatting</h1>
  <p>This text is styled with some of the text formatting properties. The heading uses the text-align, text-transform, and
color properties.
  The paragraph is indented, aligned, and the space between characters is specified. The underline is removed from this
colored
  <a target="_blank" href="tryit.asp?filename=trycss_text">"Try it Yourself"</a> link.</p>
</div>

</body>
</html>
```

CSS Text

Text Color

The **color** property is used to set the color of the text. The color is specified by:

- a color name - like "red"
- a HEX value - like "#ff0000"
- an RGB value - like "rgb(255,0,0)"

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
body {
  color: blue;
}

h1 {
  color: green;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>

<h1>This is heading 1</h1>
<p>This is an ordinary paragraph. Notice that this text is blue. The
default text color for a page is defined in the body selector.</p>
<p>Another paragraph.</p>

</body>
</html>
```

Note: For W3C compliant CSS: If you define the **color** property, you must also define the **background-color**.

CSS Text

Text Color and Background Color

In this example, define both the `background-color` property and the `color` property:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
body {
  background-color: lightgrey;
  color: blue;
}

h1 {
  background-color: black;
  color: white;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>

<h1>This Heading is Black with White Text</h1>
<p>This page has a grey background color and a blue text.</p>
<p>Another paragraph.</p>

</body>
</html>
```

CSS Text

CSS Text Alignment

The `text-align` property is used to set the horizontal alignment of a text.

A text can be left or right aligned, centered, or justified.

The following example shows center aligned, and left and right aligned text (left alignment is default if text direction is left-to-right, and right alignment is default if text direction is right-to-left):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
h1 {
  text-align: center;
}

h2 {
  text-align: left;
}

h3 {
  text-align: right;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<h1>Heading 1 (center)</h1>
<h2>Heading 2 (left)</h2>
<h3>Heading 3 (right)</h3>
<p>The three headings above are aligned center, left and right.</p>

</body>
</html>
```

CSS Text

When the `text-align` property is set to "justify", each line is stretched so that every line has equal width, and the left and right margins are straight (like in magazines and newspapers):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
div {
  border: 1px solid black;
  padding: 10px;
  width: 200px;
  height: 200px;
  text-align: justify;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<h1>Example text-align: justify;</h1>
<p>The text-align: justify; value stretches the lines so that each line
has equal width (like in newspapers and magazines).</p>
<div>
In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice
that I've been turning over in my mind ever since. 'Whenever you feel
like criticizing anyone,' he told me, 'just remember that all the people
in this world haven't had the advantages that you've had.'
</div>
</body>
</html>
```

CSS Text

Text Direction

The `direction` and `unicode-bidi` properties can be used to change the text direction of an element:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
p.ex1 {
  direction: rtl;
  unicode-bidi: bidi-override;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<p>This is the default text direction.</p>
<p class="ex1">This is right-to-left text direction.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

Vertical Alignment

The `vertical-align` property sets the vertical alignment of an element.

This example demonstrates how to set the vertical alignment of an image in a text:

```
img.top {
  vertical-align: top;
}

img.middle {
  vertical-align: middle;
}

img.bottom {
  vertical-align: bottom;
}
```

CSS Text

CSS Text Decoration

The `text-decoration` property is used to set or remove decorations from text.

The value `text-decoration: none;` is often used to remove underlines from links:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
a {
  text-decoration: none;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<p>A link with no underline: <a href="https://www.w3schools.com">W3Schools.com</a></p>
</body>
</html>
```

The other `text-decoration` values are used to decorate text:

```
h1 {
  text-decoration: overline;
}

h2 {
  text-decoration: line-through;
}

h3 {
  text-decoration: underline;
}
```

Note: It is not recommended to underline text that is not a link, as this often confuses the reader.

CSS Text

CSS Text Transformation

The `text-transform` property is used to specify uppercase and lowercase letters in a text.

It can be used to turn everything into uppercase or lowercase letters, or capitalize the first letter of each word:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
<style>
p.uppercase {
  text-transform: uppercase;
}

p.lowercase {
  text-transform: lowercase;
}

p.capitalize {
  text-transform: capitalize;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<p class="uppercase">This is some text.</p>
<p class="lowercase">This is some text.</p>
<p class="capitalize">This is some text.</p>
</body>
</html>
```


CSS Text

CSS Text Spacing

Text Indentation

The `text-indent` property is used to specify the indentation of the first line of a text:

```
p {  
  text-indent: 50px;  
}
```

Letter Spacing

The `letter-spacing` property is used to specify the space between the characters in a text.

The following example demonstrates how to increase or decrease the space between characters:

```
h1 {  
  letter-spacing: 3px;  
}  
  
h2 {  
  letter-spacing: -3px;  
}
```

Line Height

The `line-height` property is used to specify the space between lines:

```
p.small {  
  line-height: 0.8;  
}  
  
p.big {  
  line-height: 1.8;  
}
```

CSS Text

Word Spacing

The `word-spacing` property is used to specify the space between the words in a text.

The following example demonstrates how to increase or decrease the space between words:

```
h1 {  
  word-spacing: 10px;  
}  
  
h2 {  
  word-spacing: -5px;  
}
```

White Space

The `white-space` property specifies how white-space inside an element is handled.

This example demonstrates how to disable text wrapping inside an element:

```
p {  
  white-space: nowrap;  
}
```

CSS Text Shadow

Text Shadow

The `text-shadow` property adds shadow to text.

In its simplest use, you only specify the horizontal shadow (2px) and the vertical shadow (2px):

Text shadow effect!

```
h1 {  
  text-shadow: 2px 2px;  
}
```

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Next, add a color (red) to the shadow:

Text shadow effect!

```
h1 {  
  text-shadow: 2px 2px red;  
}
```

Then, add a blur effect (5px) to the shadow:

Text shadow effect!

```
h1 {  
  text-shadow: 2px 2px 5px red;  
}
```

All CSS Text Properties

Property	Description
color	Sets the color of text
direction	Specifies the text direction/writing direction
letter-spacing	Increases or decreases the space between characters in a text
line-height	Sets the line height
text-align	Specifies the horizontal alignment of text
text-decoration	Specifies the decoration added to text
text-indent	Specifies the indentation of the first line in a text-block
text-shadow	Specifies the shadow effect added to text
text-transform	Controls the capitalization of text
text-overflow	Specifies how overflowed content that is not displayed should be signaled to the user
unicode-bidi	Used together with the direction property to set or return whether the text should be overridden to support multiple languages in the same document
vertical-align	Sets the vertical alignment of an element
white-space	Specifies how white-space inside an element is handled
word-spacing	Increases or decreases the space between words in a text